
THE CAMBRIDGE HARKENER

CELEBRATING THE HERITAGE OF CAMBRIDGE, VERMONT

Vol. II, No. 2

Winter 2003

Current Officers

Co-Presidents: Clark Dodge, Roberta Marsh

Vice President: Joel Page

Secretary: Geana Little

Treasurer: Bill Putnam

Directors:

Ron Bechard, Diancy Boyden,

Julie Brown, Ronnie Little,

Bill Sander, Jane Shaw, Linda Ward

Advisory Board Members: Harold Putnam, Wendell Wells

Come See the Results of our Building Project!

For over a year, the Cambridge Historical Society has been planning a building project to make Warner Lodge a safer and more accessible place to hold meetings and house our collections. Construction began at the end of October and Eli Moore Builders has been busy updating our electrical system, building a wheelchair-accessible restroom on the first floor, installing fire detection equipment, and improving access to the basement. They have done a beautiful job and we to the public!

A lot of people worked very hard to make this project happen including the CHS Board and Building Committee, Eli Moore and his crew, Jourdan Electric, CT Plumbing (handrails), Brighter Envisions (paint), architect Michael Gohl, Stearns, and more volunteers than we can name. Funding was provided by the Preservation Trust of Vermont, the State of Vermont Capital Fund, the Vermont Arts Council. The



The new entryway!

They are ready to reopen our doors

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would like to issue a hearty *Thank you* to everyone involved!

Please come help us celebrate at an open house and potluck supper in February (*details inside*).

—Doug Porter

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Officer and Committee Reports

Collections Committee Report

The Society's Collections Committee met on November 15, 2002. The group reviewed Museum Alliance handbook guidelines on receiving and caring for historical items. It is important that items come to the Society in an orderly fashion, probably at specified times. This system will enable volunteers to get information onto the computer and ledger records. Each item will have an ID number as well as donor and history records. A contract then is given the donor as the item or items transfer ownership. The system will work well if there are no "orphan" items left with no data. Items lacking the necessary information may need to be returned or disposed of at the Committee's discretion.

We will have to find funds for the special conservation supplies needed to preserve the artifacts. The Committee reviewed special ways to mark items permanently, to wrap textiles in sheeting, to tag with a code number and how to use clear mylar enclosures. Funds also will be needed to pay for shelving, display cases and whatever storage is necessary to protect the Collection. Please call Linda Ward or Diancy Boyden, Chairmen, for any additional information.

—Carol Bacon



Treasurer's Report

Balance 1/1/2002 **\$ 6,910.38**

Receipts

Calendar Sales	\$ 3,335.00
Dues	950.00
Food Sale	815.83
Lawn Sale	765.00
T-Shirt Sales	330.00
Donations	3,392.02
Preservation Trust Grant	14,646.00
Interest	3,158.97
Trans from Money Market	11,146.00
Misc.	<u>315.91</u>

Total Receipts **\$38,854.73**

Expenses

Accounting	\$ 400.00
Calendar Expense	1,955.00
Insurance	872.00
Building Expense	
Renovations	29,302.00
Architect	7,105.00
Utilities	
Electricity	323.08
Fuel Oil	1,004.97
Water & Sewer	30.00
Other	86.73
Lawn Mowing	184.00
Presentations	50.00
Postage	224.96
Supplies	146.50
Misc.	<u>49.00</u>

Total Expenses **\$41,733.24**

Balance 12/31/2002 **\$ 4,031.87**

Inventory of Cash Assets 12/31/2002

Checking Account Balance	\$ 4,031.87
Money Market Balance	19,393.92
Putnam Memorial Fund CD	25,000.00
Approx. Accrued Interest	158.86
Proctor & Gamble Stock	<u>1,202.60</u>

Total Assets **\$49,767.25**

Building Project Recapitulation

Receipts

Grants	
Preservation Trust of Vermont	\$25,000.00
State of Vermont	19,940.00
Town of Cambridge	10,000.00
VT Arts Council (not yet rec'd)	<u>3,750.00</u>
Total Receipts	\$58,690.00

Disbursements

Eli Moore Builders (Paid to date)	\$29,302.00
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Balance for Building Completion **\$29,388.00**

—Bill Putnam

The Final Resting Place

On November 6, 2001, after nearly 200 years, the remains of John Wood and his wife were exhumed from their original hilltop grave site on their Cambridge farm overlooking their home-
stead.

After being studied by the Smithsonian Institution, they were returned for burial in



Mountain View Cemetery in Cambridge, Vermont, where other Wood family members are buried.

The morning of June 15th dawned cool, damp and rainy, much like November 6th, the date of the exhumation. I was almost

certain John had put a curse on us for disturbing them from their chosen burial place in the early 1800s. We arrived at the cemetery about 9:30 A.M. What a drastic change from the first burial in the mode of transportation! Gone were the horses or oxen and wagons to be replaced by sleek black automobiles. A tent covered the grave site, shielding mourners from the rain; a cement vault in the ground would protect the modern metal casket from the elements. A military funeral had been organized to honor this Revolutionary War soldier.

Members of the Cambridge Historical Society, Hayes Rich Funeral Home personnel and news reporters and photographers from local papers joined descendants of John and Hannah gathered for the full military service conducted by the Vermont National Guard for the Revolutionary War soldier, pioneer and early Cambridge settler. Pastor Elizabeth Griffin held a committal service. The flag was presented to Burnham Wood Carchrie, age 83 years, the great great grandson of John Wood.

One deranged (or brave) old woman came to the service dressed in attire that might have been fashionable in the 1800s. I can tell you first hand that this old lady wasn't so crazy after all, as she was warm and well protected from the mosquitoes and inclement weather by all the layers of heavy garments.

After the memorial service the entourage retired to the Historical Society Hall for refreshments and a presentation on the art/work of a forensic anthropologist. Slides were shown of the November 6th exhumation. Mr. Frolich and Dr. Morrow explained their findings on what they thought might have caused John's death. His

many bone fractures and the degree of trauma to his skull, both front and back, indicated he had met with some terrible accident. The fractures showed no healing process had taken place, which would suggest he died fairly soon, if not immediately, after the accident, whatever it might have been.

Hannah was found to have suffered from arthritis and osteoporosis. At some time she had fractures of the wrist and collarbone, but these had healed prior to the time of her death.

We will never solve the how, where or why of their deaths. However, these events, started on November 6, 2001 and culminating on June 15, 2002, will continue to tweak the imaginations of those of us who find the history of our community and its earliest settlers so interesting.

"To know our past helps to lead us into our future."

The trials and tribulations our ancestors endured may be different from those of our times, but the legacy they left us continues on - as will ours, when we become the ancestors that our descendants talk and read about.

This inscription, found on an early gravestone, tells the whole story.

*Remember as you pass on by
As you are now, so once was I
As I am now, so you shall be*

Returned to earth both you and me.

My only regret about the second burial was that there was no mention of John's wife, Hannah, whose remains were contained in the casket with those of John. I was told that, because it was a military service to honor him, it wasn't possible to mention her. I understood that, but a simple reference to her could have been made after the Guard had withdrawn and before the people left. After all, we sat among the headstones of some of their children during the service; and surely, John did not give birth to any babies!!

She had done her share in her days on this earth and should have been recognized with at least a mention of her name.



Well, Mrs. Wood, I did it my way! Before we left I silently gave you the grandest farewell that ever existed!!

Back then, as now, behind every good man there stands a good (or maybe even better) woman. If you don't believe this is true, just ask any woman!!!!

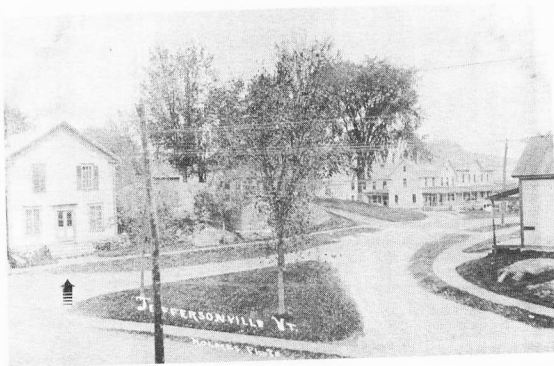
—June Dodge

History of the Warner Lodge Building

Warner Lodge #50 was chartered January 12, 1860. Those signing the dispensation were Amos Kingsbury of LaPort Lodge in Indiana, Levi L. Smith, Lyman Austin, and Charles Turner of Lamoille Lodge #6 and the following former members of Cambridge Union Lodge #64, Elias Chadwick, John Warner, Giles Barber and Nathaniel Reed. The dispensation was granted and the first three officers were appointed, viz., Amos Kingsbury, W.M., Elias Chadwick, S.W. and Levi L. Smith, J.W.

The period of dispensation, July 7, 1859 to January 12, 1860 was indeed a busy one. Among the many items considered was a permanent meeting place. The committee in charge was apparently unsuccessful as they never reported and we find the matter coming up now and then for several years.

The matter of a suitable Lodge Room came up again in 1866, when a committee was appointed to investigate the best measures to take to build or procure a new Lodge Room and report at a special communication and take such further action as shall be expedient. It was voted to instruct the committee to accept the proposition offered by Mr. W. Griswold and also be empowered to raise money and make contracts as they think best and for the best interest of the Lodge. Up to this time



The original location next to Melvin's store

we do not know where the Lodge held its communications. From this time on the Lodge apparently met in the present hall which stood near the Melvin Store at the head of Main Street.

The years 1910 and 1911 were a busy time for the members. Mr. Melvin offered to trade the lot where the Temple presently stands for the lot near his store, provided the Lodge move the building to the new site.

After obtaining a deed to the property from W. H. Griswold and receiving a report from a committee consisting of W.C. Mudgett, Eugene C.

Wells and Martin M. Powell on the condition of the building and the costs of moving it, the offer was accepted, the necessary deeds executed and the building moved.



The new location on Brewster Avenue
(now School Street)

On March 23, 1911, the Temple had arrived at the new location and was ready to be let down on the new foundation.

At about this time a committee was appointed, consisting of Eugene C. Wells, Charles A. Horner and A.L. Brown to draw plans and estimate the cost of repairs. At this time the partition between the Lodge Room and the Anteroom was removed and an addition built on the rear of the building and an entrance on the side. The sidewalls in the Lodge Room were covered with wallpaper with a figure of a large Masonic emblem. At the completion of the work the sum of \$1500 was borrowed to pay for the work. The note was finally paid and the mortgage discharged on April 11, 1930 and Warner Lodge owned its home.

A very few meetings have been omitted for various reasons. One occurred on November 3, 1927 during the big flood. We were very fortunate that there was no damage except for the mud in the basement.

On November 1, 2000, the Cambridge Historical Society purchased the Warner Lodge building for \$55,000.00. In January, 2003, the first round of renovations were complete and the Society now has a modernized building with a permanent link to the past. Living links to that past are members Charlie and Stub Wells. Both are Masons and were members of Warner Lodge. Charlie boasts 75 years as a Mason, while Stub can claim only 70. The Society is privileged to have such an historic building as its home.

—excerpted from a
"History of Masonry in Cambridge, Vermont"
by Brother Robert M. Leach (Jan, 1960)

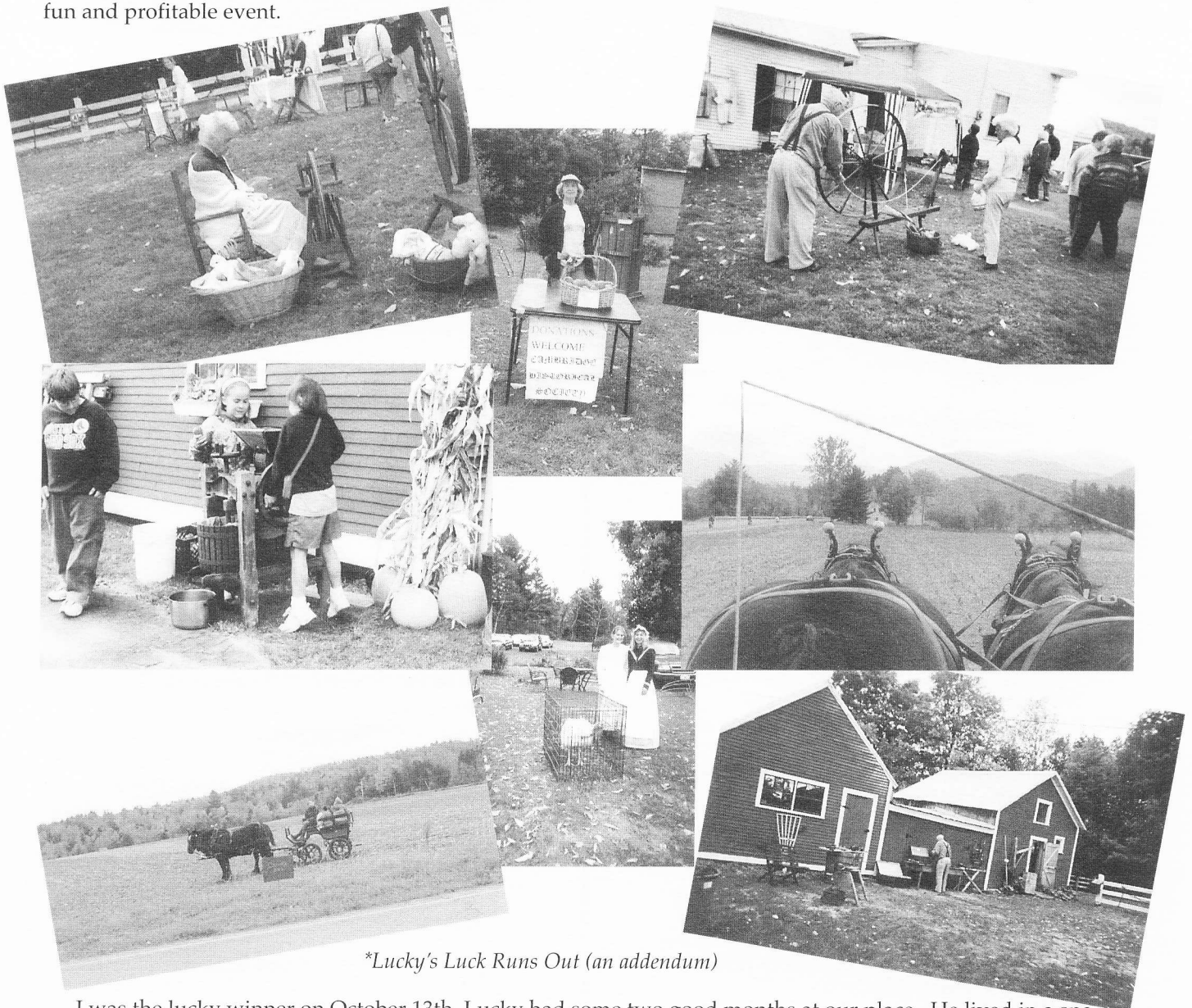
Old Farm and Home Days—October 12th & 13th, 2002

The first annual Old Farm Days, held over the Columbus Day weekend, was a resounding success. Although planned on short notice, everything came together to produce a great time for locals and tourists alike. It seemed that the only place in northern Vermont where it wasn't raining was over the Dodge Homestead on Route 108 South. The Dodges generously donated their homestead for the festivities and brought out their old home and farm equipment to show the 21st century how it was done in the 19th. There were demonstrations of spinning, weaving, apple pressing, clothes washing and ironing and woodworking. Visitors could watch a pro do the work or attempt to work the equipment themselves, with varying degrees of success.

Linda Ward once again brought her beautiful Percheron horses and offered carriage rides for a donation to the Society. She also donated a turkey to be raffled off. This bird, eventually dubbed Lucky, was within hours of leaving this earth when he was won by Jules Eberhard who wanted him, not for dinner, but as a pet* (*see below*).

The Society sold t-shirts, posters, homemade apple and pumpkin pies, cold cider, hot mulled cider and hot coffee. All in all, we took in over \$1,200.00.

This event is destined to become an annual occurrence. To all who helped by donating time and/or food (you know who you are), we say "Thank you". We hope next year to expand and recruit more members to help out at this fun and profitable event.



**Lucky's Luck Runs Out (an addendum)*

I was the lucky winner on October 13th. Lucky had some two good months at our place. He lived in a spacious chicken coop with access to a fenced in playground. The bird was well fed. His only complaint: no playmate (except me, of course!) He died on December 12, 2002 at Marcel Masse's "Poultry Processing" place in Craftsbury. Weight—close to 50 pounds!

—5—

—Jules Eberhard

Coming Events

February 8

9:00 am to Noon

Clean up at the Warner Lodge Building
Bring supplies and elbow grease

February 12

6:00 pm

Open House & Pot Luck Dinner
Warner Lodge Building
(Please bring your own plates and silverware)

March 12

7:00 pm

Monthly Meeting
Warner Lodge Building

March 21

7:00 pm

The Crescendo Club presents
Howard Coffin—Civil War Expert
Warner Lodge Building

April 9

7:00 pm

Monthly Meeting
Warner Lodge Building

May 14

7:00 pm

Monthly Meeting
Warner Lodge Building

June 21 & 22

Vermont History Expo—Tunbridge

* * * * *

Cambridge at the Vermont History Expo

For the 1st time, the Cambridge Historical Society will have a booth at the statewide History Expo in Tunbridge in June.

Our subject is uniquely Cambridge

*John Wood-From Grave to Grave
The Exhumation and Reinterment of an Early Settler*

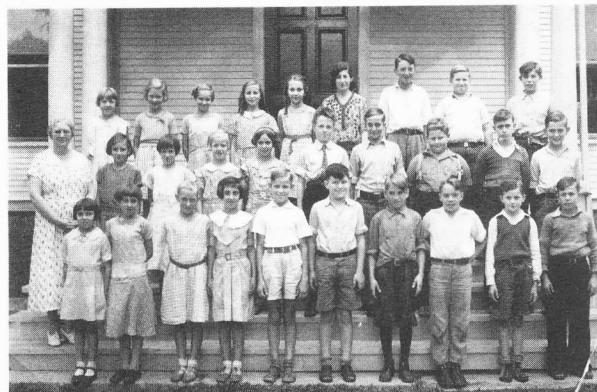
We can use help in planning and preparing the exhibit as well as staffing the booth. We need input on designing the exhibit and people with artistic ability to put it together. We will also need people to help set up the booth on Friday, June 20th and to staff it on both Saturday and Sunday.

This is a great opportunity to showcase our town and put the rest of the state to shame. If you want to volunteer (and who wouldn't), please contact Roberta Marsh (644-2678).

This should be a project that represents the whole community, so please consider lending your voice and hands.

Mystery Photograph IDed

You all probably remember this photograph which appeared in our last newsletter.



Below is a list of the pupils as identified by Rex Gates. Let the arguments begin!

Front Row

Greta King, Wilma Sweet, Jesse Griffin, Barbara Corse, Horace Cutler, John McGovern, ?, Archie King, Rex Gates, Albert Boudreau

Middle Row

Sadie Marsh - Teacher, ?, Ester Sweet, Lunesta Humphrey, Joyce Sweet, ?, Rudolph Boudreau, Everett Stratton, Francis LaPointe, Earl Cutler

Back Row

Mae Flintom, Betty Horner, Wanda Sweet, Ethel Wood, Frances Ann Dibble, Eunice Trombley, Doug Tobin, Curtis McCuin, Allen Howard

* * * * *

Special Donation

In December the Society received a nice windfall — \$2,750 from Smugglers' Notch Resort. It seems the grandson of one of our members, who works at the resort, recommended the Historical Society be the recipient of the proceeds from their "Vermont Country Fair", a weekly event held for the guests featuring games, music, crafts and other entertainment. The proceeds are donated to local non-profits. We wish to thank **Aaron Heyer** for placing our name on the recipient list. The money is much needed and appreciated..

* * * * *

Wish List

Things we would like, if you have them lying around!

Computer Equipment (computers, printers, etc.)
Shelving Storage Cabinets Filing Cabinets

2003 Membership Application/Renewal

Please complete this form and mail to: Cambridge Historical Society
P.O. Box 16
Jeffersonville, Vt 05464

☐ New

☐ Renewal

Name _____

Address _____

Number

Street

Town

State

Zip

Phone _____ E-Mail _____

Membership Category

In future, only paid up members will receive a copy of The Harkener

☐ Individual \$10.00

☐ Family \$15.00

☐ Business \$25.00

☐ Individual Life \$100.00

Please consider becoming a:

☐ Patron \$500.00

☐ Benefactor \$1000.00+

If you are a lifetime member you do not need to renew your membership.
However, if you wish to make a donation it would be much appreciated.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

If you have suggestions about program topics or have some great ideas for fundraisers,
please let us know by listing your ideas below.

RENEW YOUR MEMBERSHIP NOW!

Cambridge Historical Society
P. O. Box 16
Jeffersonville, VT 05464

